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PORTFOLIO / BEGINNERS

ANOTHER PROJECT LEFT UNFINISHED?

A 5-STEP RESCUE PLAN YOU CAN SAVE

1. Write the real user problem
2. Cut scope to three features
3. Finish one end-to-end flow
4. Test unhappy paths
5. Deploy and observe

KEY TAKEAWAY

FINISH SOMETHING SMALL BEFORE STARTING ANOTHER.

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PROJECT RESCUE / 01

DEFINE ONE USER PROBLEM.

NOT A LIST OF TECH FEATURES

TOO BIG

"A platform for everything students need"

SMALL ENOUGH

"A reader that remembers my last page"

KEY TAKEAWAY

IF IT TAKES A PARAGRAPH, NARROW THE IDEA.

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PROJECT RESCUE / 02

CHOOSE ONLY THREE FEATURES.

THE REST BELONGS IN LATER VERSIONS

1. **BROWSE**
   Find a useful item

2. **OPEN**
   See its details

3. **CONTINUE**
   Save your progress

KEY TAKEAWAY

YOUR FIRST VERSION IS A FINISH LINE, NOT A WISHLIST.

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PROJECT RESCUE / 03

ONE FLOW FROM START TO FINISH.

DESIGN FOR A USER, NOT A SCREENSHOT

SEARCH
Find a book

OPEN
Read details

READ
Start reading

SAVE
Keep progress

RETURN
Pick up later

KEY TAKEAWAY

A COMPLETE FLOW TEACHES YOU REAL ENGINEERING.

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PROJECT RESCUE / 04

TEST WHEN THINGS GO WRONG.

LOADING / EMPTY / ERROR / MOBILE

LOADING

Show honest progress

EMPTY

Explain the next step

ERROR

Let the user retry

MOBILE

Try real touch flow

KEY TAKEAWAY

A PRETTY HAPPY PATH IS NOT A COMPLETE PROJECT.

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PROJECT RESCUE / 05

DEPLOY IT.
WATCH SOMEONE USE IT.

LIVE LINK / README / ONE REAL USER

1. **DEPLOY**
   Put it online
2. **DOCUMENT**
   Write a simple README
3. **SHARE**
   Send one person the link
4. **OBSERVE**
   Do not explain the interface
5. **FIX**
   Improve the first confusing step

KEY TAKEAWAY

A WORKING PROJECT IS A BETTER TEACHER.